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1 Electric Vehicle Charging As A Service In India

2 "Constant Analysis Of Information To Generate Real-Time Insights Enhances The Value Of Data"

3 Smart Manufacturing Moves From Autonomous To Intelligent

1

GREEN TECH:

ELECTRIC VEHICLE CHARGING As A Service In India

➤ Safety is a major concern when it comes to powerful electric feeders (DC charging stations) or charging stations near petrol pumps or other flammables

The push to increase customer base of electric vehicles (EVs) is evident from various initiatives being taken worldwide. For example, the UK's Road to Zero campaign, which aims to end the sales of new conventional petrol and diesel vehicles, has led to an increase in awareness about EVs.

With the adoption of EVs, development of electric vehicle supply equipment (EVSE) remains a key factor for accelerating the transition. This includes charging and battery-swapping technologies. In the US, Michigan's two biggest utilities, DTE Energy and Consumers Energy, have recently launched programmes to subsidise EV charging stations.

In India, number of challenges need to be addressed to shift to clean transport systems. For public charging infrastructure, operators face difficulty in obtaining various approvals and areas for setting up at low rates. In urban environments, availability of sites is a major issue. Space is needed especially for three- and four-wheelers while these are charged. In metropolitan cities like New Delhi, which have a large number of vehicles, the EV charging network needs to be concen-



trated as charging time varies with the type of charging stations.

Safety is a major concern when it comes to powerful electric feeders (DC charging stations) or charging stations near petrol pumps or other flammables. Decisions need to be made based on the number of charging stations, type of charging stations at each location, availability of electrical grid capacity and so on to cover user needs.

Even charging stations that have already been built are not fully utilised due to the low number of EVs, which

are mostly working on home charging. When the supply chain is not mature, it leads to low post-sales support.

To overcome these challenges, the government, automakers and charging infrastructure providers are coming up with solutions to manufacture and install EVSE infrastructure across India.

The Indian automotive industry is expected to reach ₹ 18 trillion (approximately) by 2026, according to a report by India Brand Equity Foundation (IBEF). The government of India is